Veteran Benefits Kit

SCHOOL AND THE GI BILL

I don't know which benefit I have

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

I haven't been paid

Which benefit are you using?

GI Bill or DEA:

Has the certifying office certified your classes for this term?

Yes, and it matches my schedule:

Have you verified your enrollment with VA this month?

Yes:

Is this your first payment of the term?

Yes, the first one:

The school's part is done. It's VA's clock now. Allow 7 to 10 business days after you verify · Past that, call VA → *VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

No, a regular monthly payment:

The school's part is done. It's VA's clock now. Verify this month first · Past 7 to 10 business days after verifying, call VA → *VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

No, or I'm not sure:

Verify your enrollment now. Verify on va.gov, or by text, email or phone · Then give it a few days → *VA Education Call Center*

Yes, but something is wrong:

Get the certification fixed first. Tell the certifying office exactly what is wrong · They amend it with VA → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No, or I'm not sure:

Start with the certifying office. Contact the certifying office · If not, ask what is missing · Expect a wait on a first certification → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

VR&E:

Ask your VR&E counselor. Ask the certifying office one question · Then contact your counselor → *ODU certifying office (SCO), Your VR&E counselor*

Not sure:

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

How much will VA pay me?

Which benefit are you using?

Post-9/11 GI Bill or Fry:

Use the Semester Pay Planner. Have your term and classes handy · Post-9/11: two things decide housing · Confirm with the certifying office → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

VR&E:

Use the Semester Pay Planner. Have your term and classes handy · Post-9/11: two things decide housing · Confirm with the certifying office → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Montgomery (30 or 1606) or DEA (35):

Your rate is set by your training time. Ask the certifying office which band they certify · Look up that band's rate → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Not sure:

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

I registered. How do I get certified?

Which benefit are you using?

GI Bill or DEA:

Is this your first term at ODU, or did something change?

Yes, first term or something changed:

Send the Veterans Clearance Form. Register for your classes first · Submit the Veterans Clearance Form with your COE · Allow 30 to 45 business days → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No, I'm continuing with no changes:

Ask the certifying office if a form is due. Ask: "Do I need a new clearance form this term?" · Active duty, MEM Ashore, or a certificate program? → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

VR&E:

Nothing for you to send. Ask the certifying office if it arrived → *ODU certifying office (SCO), Your VR&E counselor*

Not sure:

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

I want to drop or withdraw from a class

Which benefit are you using?

GI Bill or DEA:

Has the class started yet?

Not yet:

Tell the certifying office the same day. Drop it, then tell the certifying office that day · Ask whether any money was already paid on it → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Yes, it has started:

Is it still inside the add/drop period?

Yes, still inside add/drop:

Drop it, and tell the certifying office that day. Tell the certifying office the day you drop · Don't plan money on it yet → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No, it's past add/drop:

Stop. Talk to the certifying office before you drop. Contact the certifying office first · Give your reasons in writing when you drop · Know the deadline → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Not sure:

Stop. Talk to the certifying office before you drop. Contact the certifying office first · Give your reasons in writing when you drop · Know the deadline → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

VR&E:

Talk to your counselor before you drop. Contact your VR&E counselor first · Tell the certifying office the same day you drop → *Your VR&E counselor, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Not sure:

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Does my class count as in person?

Is it a remedial or developmental class?

Yes:

Ask the certifying office. Write down the course number → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No:

Does the class require you on campus at any point during the term?

Yes:

It counts as in person. The certifying office certifies it → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No, never:

It counts as online. Want at least one in-person class? · Check the money in the planner → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Not sure:

Write it down and ask the certifying office. Send the course number and how it meets → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Not sure:

Write it down and ask the certifying office. Send the course number and how it meets → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

How much benefit do I have left?

Which benefit are you using?

GI Bill or DEA:

Check it yourself on va.gov. Open VA's remaining-benefits page · Won't show, or the number looks wrong? → *ODU certifying office (SCO), VA Education Call Center*

VR&E:

Ask your VR&E counselor. Contact your counselor → *Your VR&E counselor*

Not sure:

Find it on paper, online, or by phone. Look at your Certificate of Eligibility or award letter · Or check online with your own sign-in · Have a VA counselor? You are on VR&E (Chapter 31) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Can I switch benefits?

Is your term already under way?

Yes:

Not in the middle of a term. Into VR&E: start with a VR&E counselor · Between GI Bill chapters: ask the certifying office → *Your VR&E counselor, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

No, I'm between terms:

Talk it through before you switch. For VR&E, talk to a VR&E counselor · Have both Montgomery and Post-9/11? · Tell the certifying office → *Your VR&E counselor, ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Do I qualify for VR&E?

Are you a veteran, or still serving?

Veteran:

Do you have both of these?

Yes, both:

You can apply. Apply on va.gov with VA Form 28-1900 · Meet with your counselor → *Your VR&E counselor*

No, or not yet:

Start with a free Veterans Service Officer. Find an accredited VSO · Come back to VR&E once you have a rating → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Not sure:

Start with a free Veterans Service Officer. Find an accredited VSO · Come back to VR&E once you have a rating → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Still serving on active duty:

There's a different doorway while serving. With a VA rating: VA Form 28-1900 · No rating yet: VA Form 28-0588 · Unsure which fits? Ask a VR&E counselor → *Your VR&E counselor, An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

BEYOND SCHOOL

A disability claim or rating

Get a free accredited representative. Find an accredited VSO · Want it in writing? Use Ask VA → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO), Ask VA, in writing*

VA health care, including mental health

Apply once, then use any VA clinic. Apply for VA health care · Need mental health care now? → *Your nearest VA clinic or Vet Center*

A VA home loan

Get your Certificate of Eligibility. Check whether you qualify · Get or check your COE · Then work with a lender

I'm leaving the military, or just got out

Use TAP, and free counseling. Still serving? Start TAP with your installation · Choosing a school or career? Free counseling (Chapter 36) · Planning school? Find your benefit first

Finding work

Two places to start. Rated 10% or more? Look at VR&E · Everyone: VA careers and employment

WORKING THE BENEFITS DESK

I work at the desk and a student needs help

Use the Front-Desk Map. Find the situation, do the one check, follow the branch · The one rule: you may assist. You never certify to VA. → *ODU certifying office (SCO)*

Every answer's sources and contact details are on the page itself, at the address below.

In crisis, or worried about a Veteran? **Dial 988, then press 1**, or text 838255 — the Veterans Crisis Line, free and confidential, 24/7 (veteranscrisisline.net).

Not an official VA document and not a VA decision. It points you to the right step and the right person. The School Certifying Official's certification and VA's award govern your case; your VR&E counselor governs anything Chapter 31. Rates and dates carry their own dates on the pages they come from.

The kit's three pages: Semester Pay Planner · Which Benefit Am I On · Front-Desk Map (for the office). Every page prints.

Public address of this page: ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/

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